

Proposal

Primary Theme: Unchecked growth of technology being mainstream and its transformation/influence on people and the environment. We will take an alarmist approach, focusing on the idea about how in trying to escape anxiety and boredom, music/technology is sought after because it is comforting and entertaining, but ultimately controlling.

Guiding Research Questions: How does digital technology disconnect people from the natural environment? How does it affect the natural environment? What relationships, practices and traditional spaces does digital technology seem to replace? What role does sound/music play in taking people away from reality? What does the influential growth of technology sound like?

Speculative Trajectory: We are imagining a future where there will no longer be silence. The growth of digital technology/music will dominate the natural world/environment. The sounds of nature, its “silence,” and all non-virtual noises will be lost or forgotten. The world will become fully saturated/replaced with artificial sound as nature, culture, and emotions are drowned out.

Presenting Through Sound: We will create a soundscape that depicts a dystopian future where technology has taken over people's lives and the natural environment. Specifically, it will follow a day in the life of what an introverted man who needs music to comfort his anxiety, using it as a drug, might hear. We plan to use looping, effects like putting on headphones/drawing out sound, to distinguish between the outside world and the inside mind of this character. We will also illustrate constant media/overlapping audio clips, as there is no more silence in this future, and the natural environment being destroyed because of this technology with birds falling from the sky. Overall, it will depict this character who can't function during social interactions and abuses music to feel at ease, whilst in a world going socially extinct with constant technological usage and the destruction of nature/silence.

Annotated Bibliography

Allen, Aaron S., and Kevin Dawe, editors. *Current Directions in Ecomusicology: Music, Culture, Nature*. 1st ed., Routledge, 2015. <https://doi.org/10.4324/9781315752938>

This source offers a comprehensive overview of ecomusicology, featuring contributions from scholars across fields such as anthropology, biology, and environmental studies. The book explores topics like acoustic ecology, material sustainability, and the environmental crisis through the lens of music and sound. Its wide range and interdisciplinary approach make it useful for understanding the multifaceted ways ecology shapes and is shaped by music.

Ingram, David. *The Jukebox in the Garden: Ecocriticism and American Popular Music Since 1960*. BRILL, 2010. ProQuest Ebook Central, <https://ebookcentral.proquest.com/lib/ucsd/detail.action?docID=617749>.

Ingram explores how American pop music has reflected and influenced environmental consciousness since the 1960s, introducing the concept of “eco-listening.” The book analyzes different genres and artists, demonstrating how music can impact ecological awareness. Its historical and multi-genre approach provides a broader cultural context for the ecological themes in music.

Jenkins, Sally. “Claiming to Be ‘Golf, but Louder,’ LIV’s Sound and Fury Signify Nothing.” *The Washington Post*, 22 Feb. 2023.

In this opinion piece, Sally Jenkins criticizes LIV Golf, arguing that while it promotes itself with flashy marketing, it lacks real meaning or tradition. She sees LIV as more of a money-driven show than a serious golf organization and questions its long-term impact on the sport. Since Jenkins is a respected sports columnist, her perspective helps show how LIV Golf is viewed in mainstream media. This article adds a strong critical voice to my research and gives insight into how some believe LIV is hurting the spirit of golf.

JIN, Zhouying, et al. "What Is Technology?" *The Future of Humanity (Second Edition): From Global Civilization to Great Civilization (Second Edition)*, 2nd ed., Intellect, 2022, pp. 97–134. *JSTOR*, <http://www.jstor.org/stable/j.ctv36xw1sr.12>. Accessed 4 May 2025.

This source breaks down what technology is fundamentally, detailing the full timeline of its development as well as predicting its future impact on society. While looking at the history of technology and different eras, it studies its relationship to mankind and the impact it has on a variety of systems on society, economy, politics, culture, the environment all together. It brings in ideas about a new way of observing technology and most importantly the challenges it poses to civilizations, which is helpful in gaining perspective on the future of technological advancement and why it needs to be controlled.

Rosen, Larry D. "The Distracted Student Mind – Enhancing Its Focus and Attention." *The Phi Delta Kappan*, vol. 99, no. 2, 2017, pp. 8–14. JSTOR, <http://www.jstor.org/stable/26388265>. Accessed 15 Apr. 2025.

This journal article focuses on the idea that students and the youth are increasingly getting distracted, predominantly by technology and their phones. It includes perspectives from teachers, and their insights on seeing their students have unclear focus as well as looks at the science behind why this “addiction” occurs. In relation to technology and sound, it looks at different forms of content consumption, like music, and notes the entering of a new technology age.

Mayor, Susan. "Listening to Music Helps Reduce Pain and Anxiety after Surgery, Review Shows." *BMJ: British Medical Journal*, vol. 351, 2015. JSTOR, <https://www.jstor.org/stable/26521492>. Accessed 20 Apr. 2025.

Mayor talks about how listening to music after surgery can help people feel less pain and stress. What makes this article special is that it looks at a bunch of different studies to prove music really works in hospitals. It shows that music can be a helpful tool for patients to feel better while healing.

Nideffer, Robert M., and Nancy D. Hessler. "Controlling Performance Anxiety." *College Music Symposium*, vol. 18, no. 1, 1978, pp. 146–53. JSTOR, <http://www.jstor.org/stable/40373929>. Accessed 20 Apr. 2025.

Nideffer and Hessler talk about how musicians can deal with performance anxiety by using mental tricks and exercises. What makes this article special is that it gives clear tips to help people stay calm and focused while performing. It shows that controlling your thoughts can really help with nerves.

Woodard, Adam. "LIV Golf Partners with an Entertainment Company to Enhance Concerts at Events." USA TODAY Sports, 19 Mar. 2024.

This article talks about LIV Golf teaming up with an entertainment company to improve the concert experience at their events. The goal is to make LIV tournaments feel more like festivals, mixing music with golf to attract a younger, more diverse crowd. This move shows how LIV is trying to stand out by offering more than just sports. The source is useful because it highlights LIV's marketing approach and how they're trying to reshape the traditional image of golf.